

PRODUCT DESIGN CASE STUDY

Fintech

B2B Marketplace

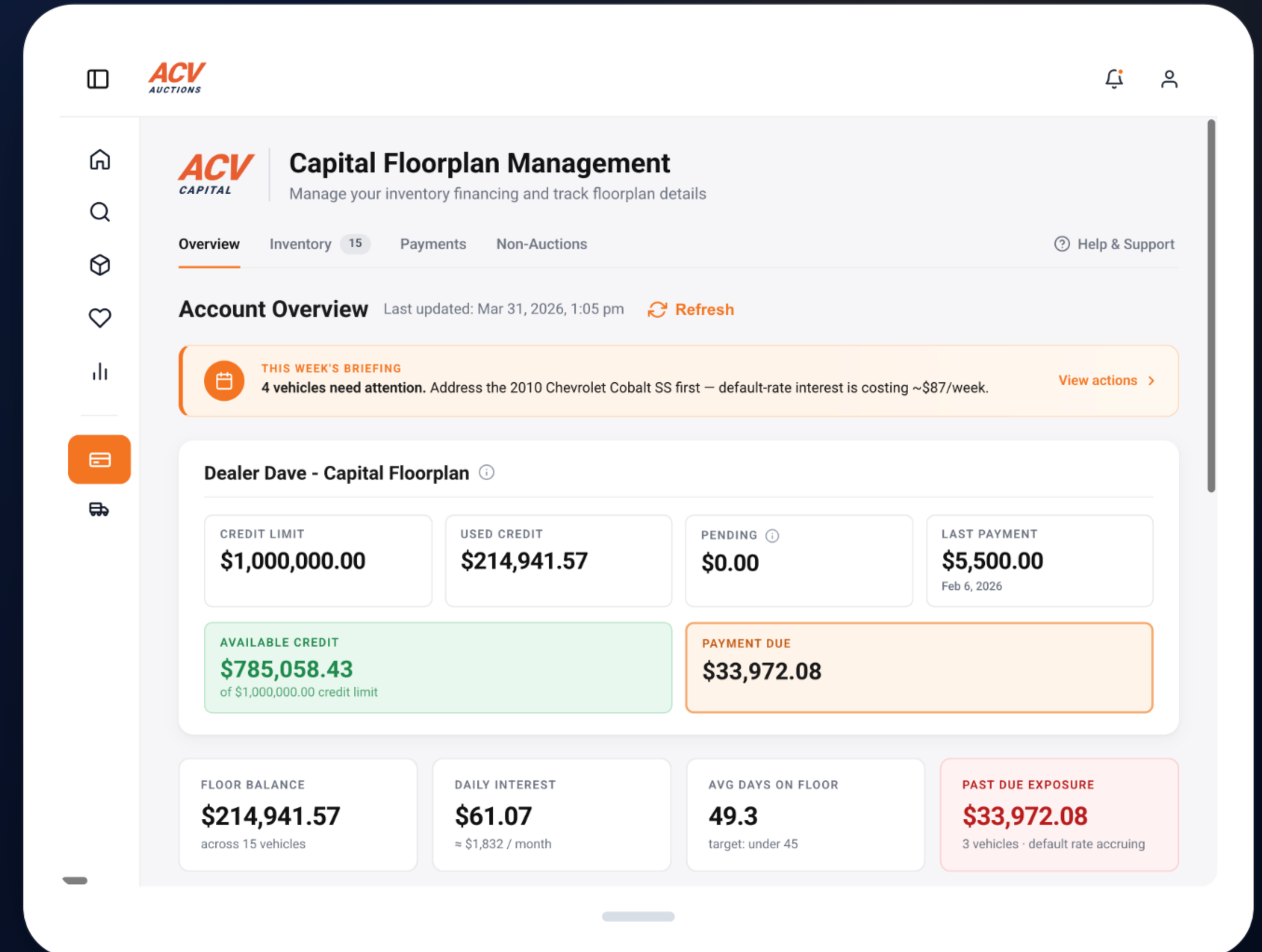
0 → 1

ACV Capital Floorplan Platform

A self-serve platform for dealers to manage floored inventory, maturities, and payments in real time.

"Self-serve, real-time financial visibility"

Margaux Kan | Senior Product Design Manager



Dealers, financing, and the black box this platform replaced

Quick context before the story: who the dealers are, what a floor plan loan is, and how it used to work.

CAR DEALERS

The customers

Independent, high-volume vehicle dealers, from small family-run lots to multi-rooftop operations, running the business from a phone, between appraisals and the lot.

THE LOAN

A "floor plan"

A revolving line of credit dealers use to buy inventory instead of paying cash upfront. They borrow to "floor" a car, then repay when it sells.

THE OLD PROCESS

A manual black box

Credit, balances, and payments lived in phone calls and spreadsheets: manual, fragmented, and invisible to the dealer until they called in.

"I have no idea how much credit I have available unless I call someone."

Independent dealer, research interview

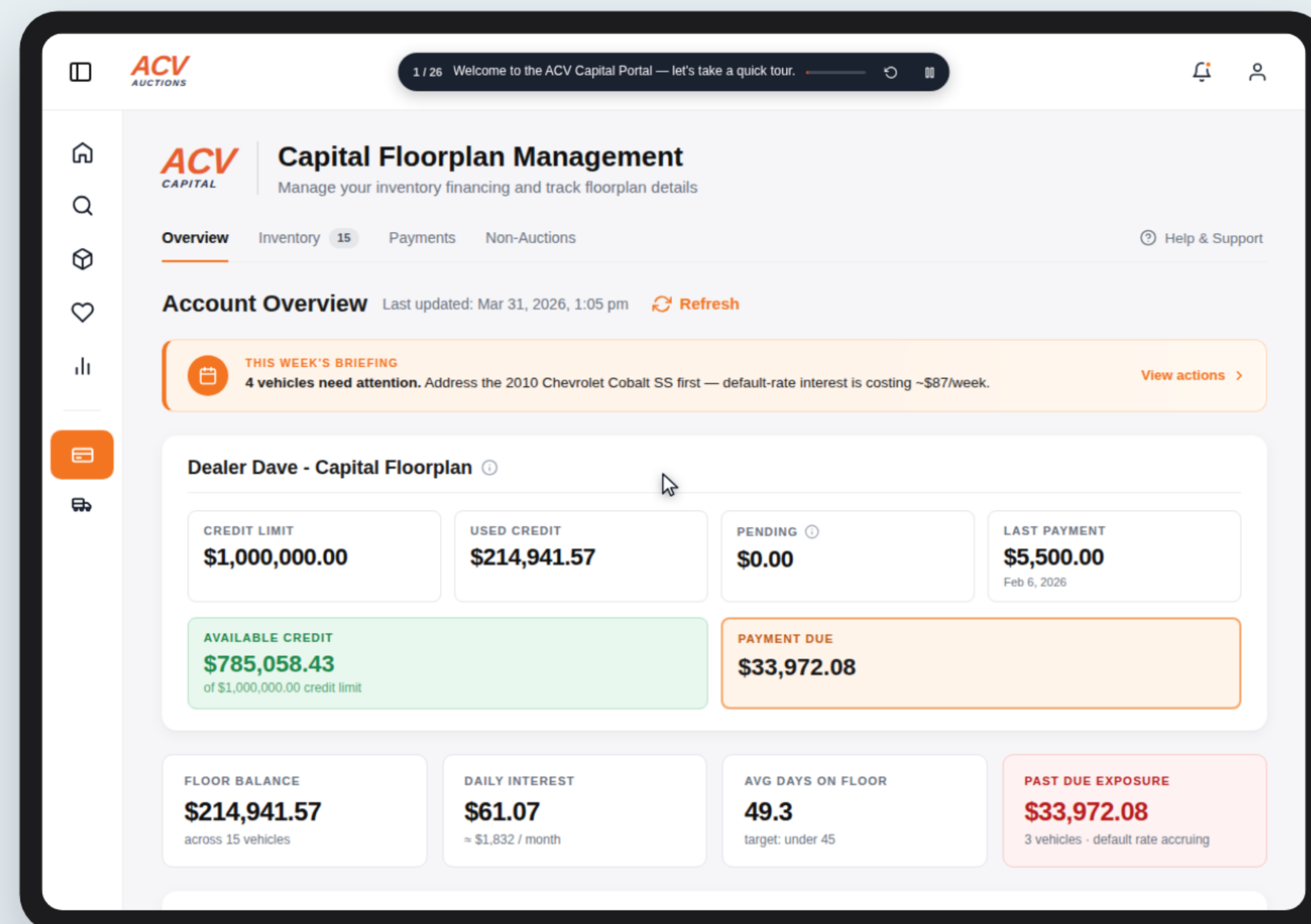
Turning dealer financing into a self-serve, real-time platform

MY ROLE

- Led 0 → 1 design for the Capital Floorplan platform, end to end
- Owned design direction and the real-time balance call; led a team of 3 designers
- Aligned Product, Engineering, Data Science, Ops, and Compliance from discovery to launch

OUTCOME

Replaced a black-box, phone-based process with a self-serve floorplan platform: real-time inventory, maturities, and payments that grew payment volume, retained top dealers, and cut operational drag.



4.6 / 5

Dealer satisfaction score, post-launch survey (up from 3.1 pre-launch)

↓ 52%

Drop in inbound service calls for balance & payment questions vs. pre-launch

90 days

From launch to active, recurring use across the platform



1 UNDERSTAND

→ 2 FRAME

→ 3 EXPLORE

→ 4 VALIDATE

→ 5 DELIVER

A high-volume financing business, still run by phone

Mission: replace phone-based financing with self-serve, real-time control of inventory, maturities, and payments.

ACV AUCTIONS**B2B Wholesale Vehicle Marketplace****ACV CAPITAL****Dealer Financing Service**

PRIMARY PERSONA

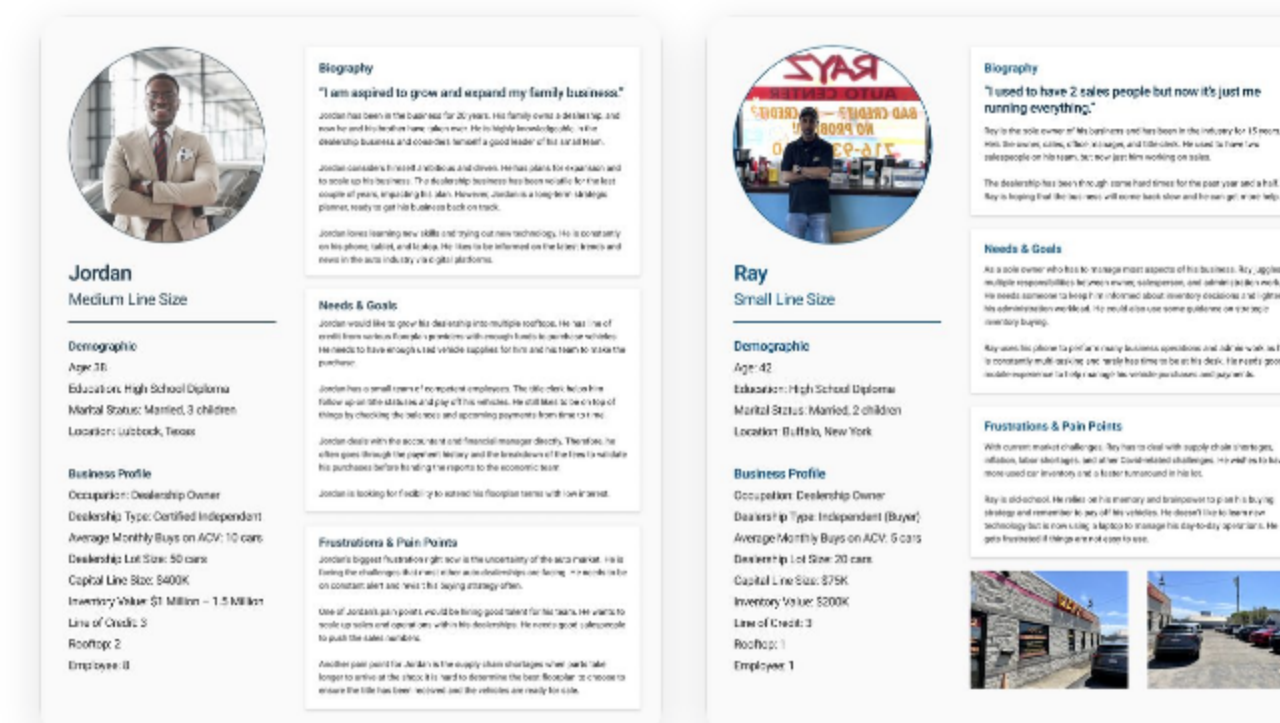
Synthesized from orchestrated dealer interviews & usability sessions: a living profile, not a static list

Independent dealer, lean team, high transaction volume

From small family-run shops to large multi-rooftop operations. \$500K to multi-million credit lines, lean teams, and limited digital tooling, running the business from a phone, between appraisals and on the lot.

"I have no idea how much credit I have available unless I call someone."

Independent dealer, research interview



Small and Medium Line Size: core users of the Capital platform



1 UNDERSTAND

**2 FRAME**

3 EXPLORE



4 VALIDATE



5 DELIVER

A retention and scale crisis, not a design polish

Executive framing: not a UI refresh, a platform bet.

THE PROBLEM

-  Payments were manual and fragmented, mostly by phone
-  Dealers had no real-time view of credit or balances
-  Ops absorbed high-volume, low-leverage inquiries



BUSINESS RISK: WHY IT MATTERED

-  Top dealers threatened to churn
-  Manual operations couldn't scale
-  Transparency gaps eroded trust in a financial product

CROSS-FUNCTIONAL & TECHNICAL

Framing this risk meant aligning Product, Engineering, Data Science, Ops, and Compliance around a shared root cause. It also meant surfacing the real-time balance data dependency early, before it became a launch blocker.

HANDS-ON

I personally mapped the problem and sketched early concepts to pressure-test feasibility with engineering before committing the team to a direction.

1 UNDERSTAND → 2 FRAME → **3 EXPLORE** → 4 VALIDATE → 5 DELIVER

Framed it as business-critical, then de-risked the hardest dependency

WHAT I LED

- Grounded design strategy in the business metrics a strong dealer experience could move, using that case to earn design a seat upstream
- Framed the self-serve portal as table stakes, not optional — competitors already had one, and dealers needed us to match it
- Aligned Product, Sales, Ops, Engineering & Compliance on one goal
- Contributed reusable patterns to ACV's Global Design System, staying hands-on through final execution details

HOW I GREW THE TEAM

- Delegated ownership of core flows; coached through ambiguity & tradeoffs
- Ran weekly critiques and 1:1s; set the bar for craft and rationale
- Coached a mid-level designer through stakeholder conflict to own the repayment flow

THE HARD CALL

Real-time balance API

Engineering flagged the live balance feed as the riskiest dependency: compliance exposure and data-accuracy risk that could have sunk the launch.

- 1 Phase 1: ship value fast**
Cached, read-only balances at launch
- 2 Phase 2: real-time, gated**
Live feed behind compliance gates + audit logging
- 3 Phase 3: full real-time**
Rolled out across the whole portfolio

Result: Unblocked launch without betting the product on one dependency.



1 UNDERSTAND → 2 FRAME → 3 EXPLORE → 4 VALIDATE → 5 DELIVER

Embedded design early to drive strategy, not just execution

GOAL Validate where trust and financial clarity were breaking down, across every perspective.

HOW I RESEARCHED

- 10 dealer interviews & usability sessions
- On-site visits + Ops workflow walkthroughs
- Embedded sessions: Sales, Product, Compliance



Dealer interview, on-site



Field visit: Buffalo, NY

ACV CAPITAL
Service Blueprint — Capital Floorplan Lifecycle
From auction purchase to title release, across the dealer experience, ACV teams, and systems team.

Customer Journey	1. Buy & Floor	2. Set Account	3. Manage Inventory & Vehicles	4. Pay, Collect, Extend	5. Title Release & Support
Physical/Online Dealer's view of the process	• ACV floorplan app • Auction bids, bids • Floor contributions	• Guided tour dashboard • "This is how it works" • Sales support	• Inventory list • Inventory status • Inventory flow (vehicles)	• Payment plans • Vehicle status • Inventory status	• Payment plan status • Inventory status • Inventory status
Customer Actions Dealer's view of the process	• Bid to buy a vehicle • Bid to buy a vehicle • Bid to buy a vehicle	• Log in • Review account credit limit • Review account credit	• New inventory • New inventory • New inventory	• Pay off vehicle • Pay off vehicle • Pay off vehicle	• Pay off vehicle • Pay off vehicle • Pay off vehicle
Personas Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process
Settings Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process
Support Processes & Systems Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process	• Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process • Dealer's view of the process

Full service blueprint

ACV CAPITAL - RESEARCH ARTIFACT
Dealer Journey Map
Floor plan financing lifecycle — current state, with emotional shift after launch

Personas: Independent & commercial dealer, Ops contact
Research inputs: Dealer interviews, on-site visits, embedded Sales/Ops/Compliance sessions

	1. GET FINANCED	2. FLOOR A VEHICLE	3. TRACK & MANAGE	4. PAY & RECONCILE	5. RENEW
DEALER GOAL	Apply for a floor plan credit line to start buying inventory	Draw against the credit line to purchase and floor a vehicle	Monitor inventory, balances, and maturities day to day	Make payments and confirm they were applied correctly	Renew the credit line to keep the buying cycle going
TOUCHPOINTS	Phone calls with Ops, paper application, email back-and-forth	Phone or email request to Ops for each draw	Personal spreadsheets, recurring phone check-ins with Ops	Phone-based payments, manual reconciliation by Ops	Phone renewal conversation, re-submission of documents
PAIN POINT	Approval handled entirely by phone, with unclear status and long turnaround	No self-serve way to draw the line — delays block time-sensitive purchases	No real-time view of balances or aging inventory	Payments manual and fragmented, mostly by phone; errors hard to trace	Manual renewal process with little visibility into terms or timing
EMOTION	• Frustrated	• Anxious	• In the dark	• Disoriented	• Uncertain
OPPORTUNITY	Self-serve application with clear, real-time status	Instant, self-serve floor-a-vehicle flow	Live dashboard with balances, aging, and alerts	Self-serve payments with instant, visible confirmation	Proactive renewal alerts + streamlined re-approval
AFTER LAUNCH	• Confident	• In control	• Informed	• Trusting	• Reassured

Map created prior to redesign to align Sales, Ops, Underwriting & Engineering on where the experience was breaking down. Post-launch emotions reflect dealer feedback after the self-serve portal shipped.

Morgan Kan - ACV Capital Case Study

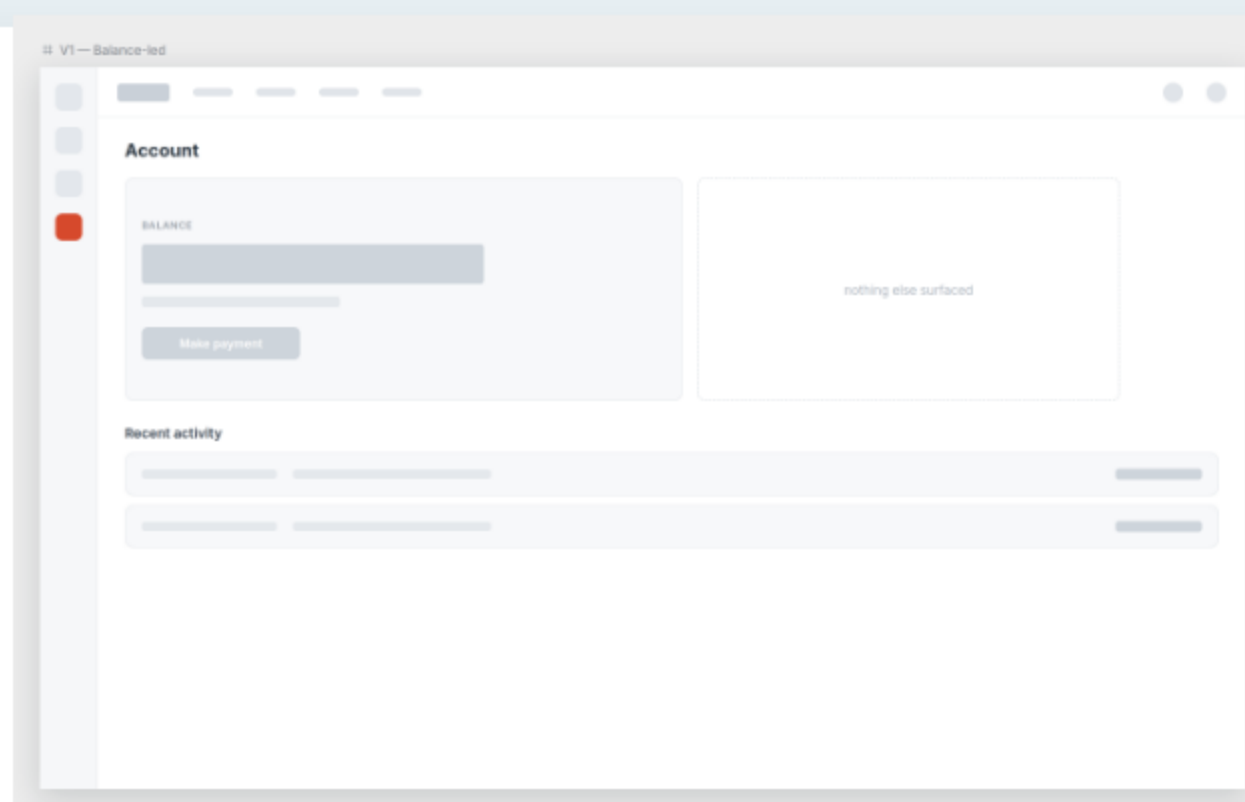
Full dealer journey map

TAKEAWAY The service blueprint and dealer journey map above (built from these visits, interviews, and workshops) became the shared reference for the redesign — they aligned Sales, Ops, Underwriting & Engineering on one view of the lifecycle, and showed exactly where the experience was breaking down.

1 UNDERSTAND → 2 FRAME → **3 EXPLORE** → 4 VALIDATE → 5 DELIVER

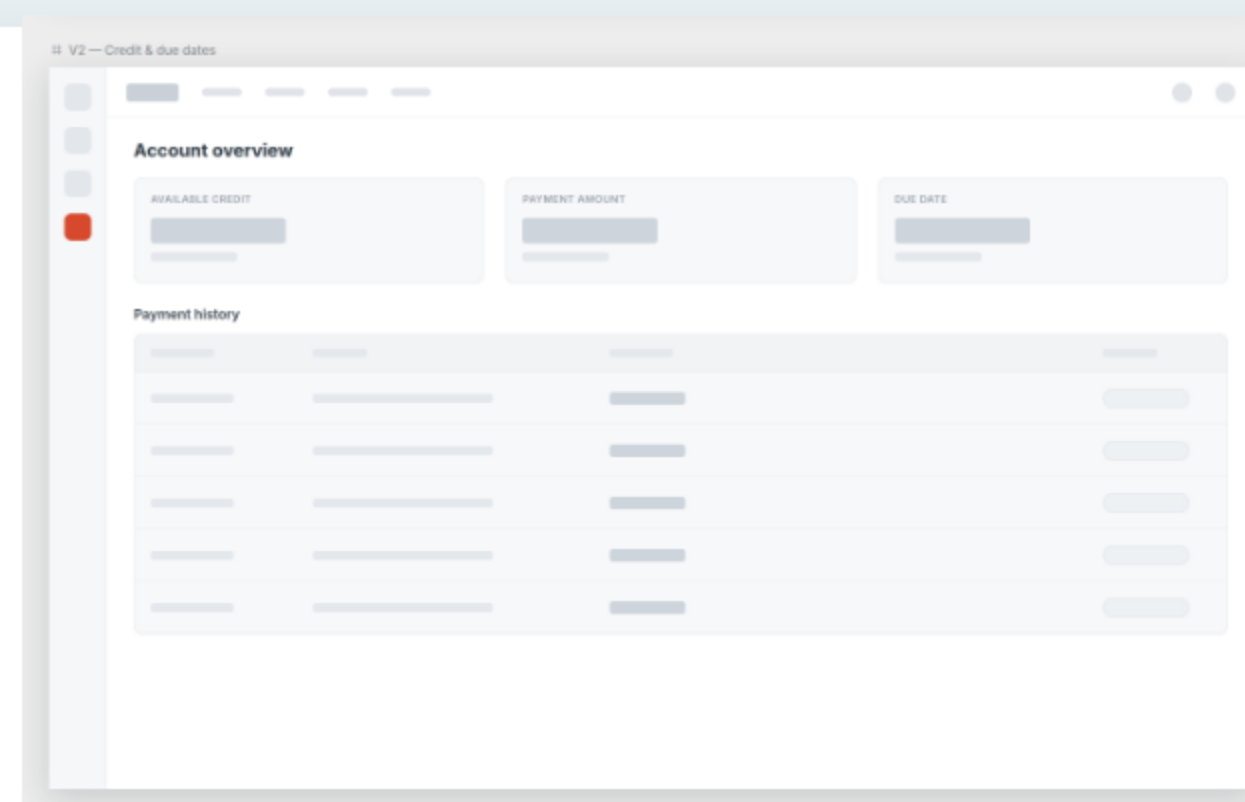
Three directions, stress-tested with dealers before committing

GOAL Find the framing that actually reduced calls and rebuilt trust, not just the cleanest screen.



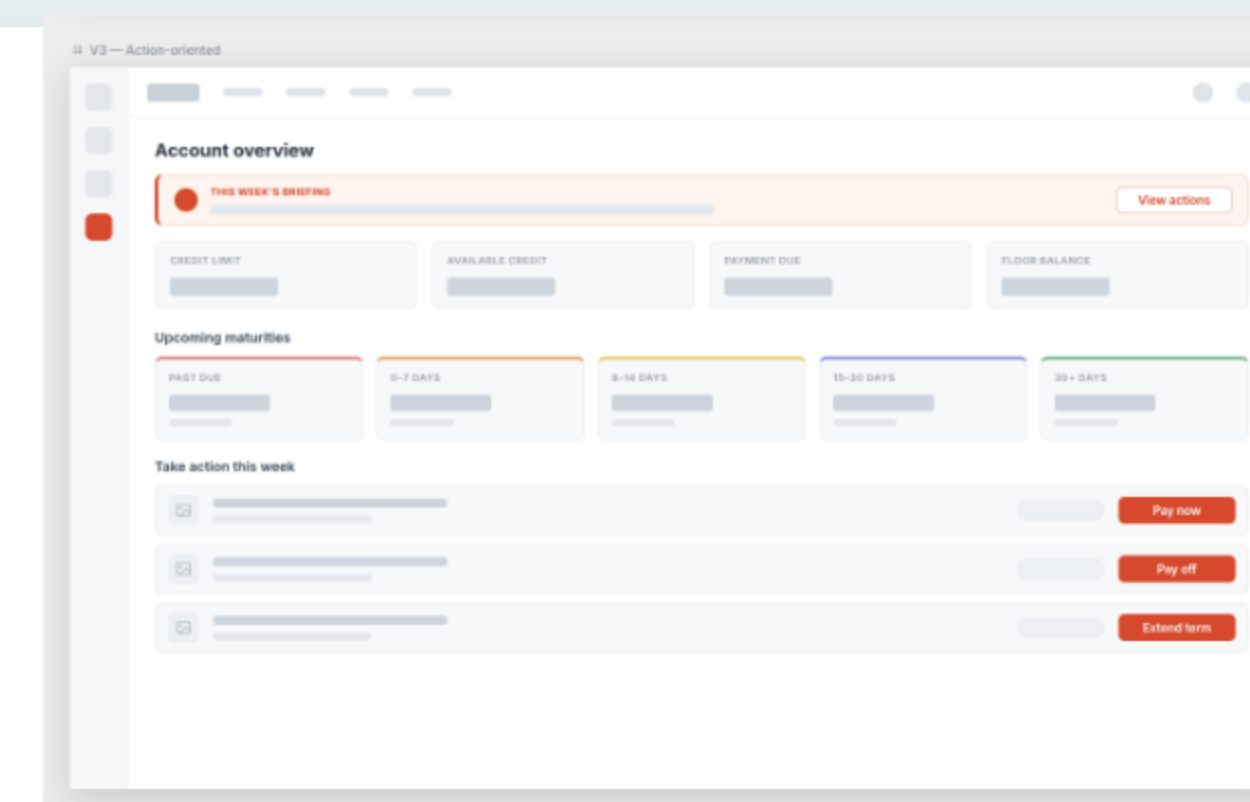
V1 • Balance-led

Led with the raw balance: clear, but it didn't answer "what do I do next?"



V2 • Credit & due dates

Led with available credit and upcoming due dates, mapped to what dealers actually decide on



V3 • Action-oriented

Surfaced one recommended next action per vehicle, ahead of any numbers

HOW THEY WERE TESTED

Moderated usability sessions with dealers, walking through realistic scenarios like checking available credit or resolving a past-due balance, and scored on clarity, trust, and task success.

Results didn't point to a single winner. They pointed to which patterns to keep, and which to drop. That decision carried into Validate.

1 UNDERSTAND → 2 FRAME → 3 EXPLORE → **4 VALIDATE** → 5 DELIVER

Reframing the experience around what dealers actually decide on

V1 · Balance-led

DROPPED

V2 · Credit & due dates

ADOPTED

V3 · Action-oriented

ADOPTED

How we narrowed: tested against clarity, trust, and task success. V2 and V3's strongest patterns were combined into the final design; V1's balance-first framing was dropped.

01

Shifted the hierarchy from raw balances to available credit, payment amounts, and due dates



02

Surfaced account details and payment history to cut calls to Support



03

Added calendar visibility and proactive due-date notifications

KEY LEARNING

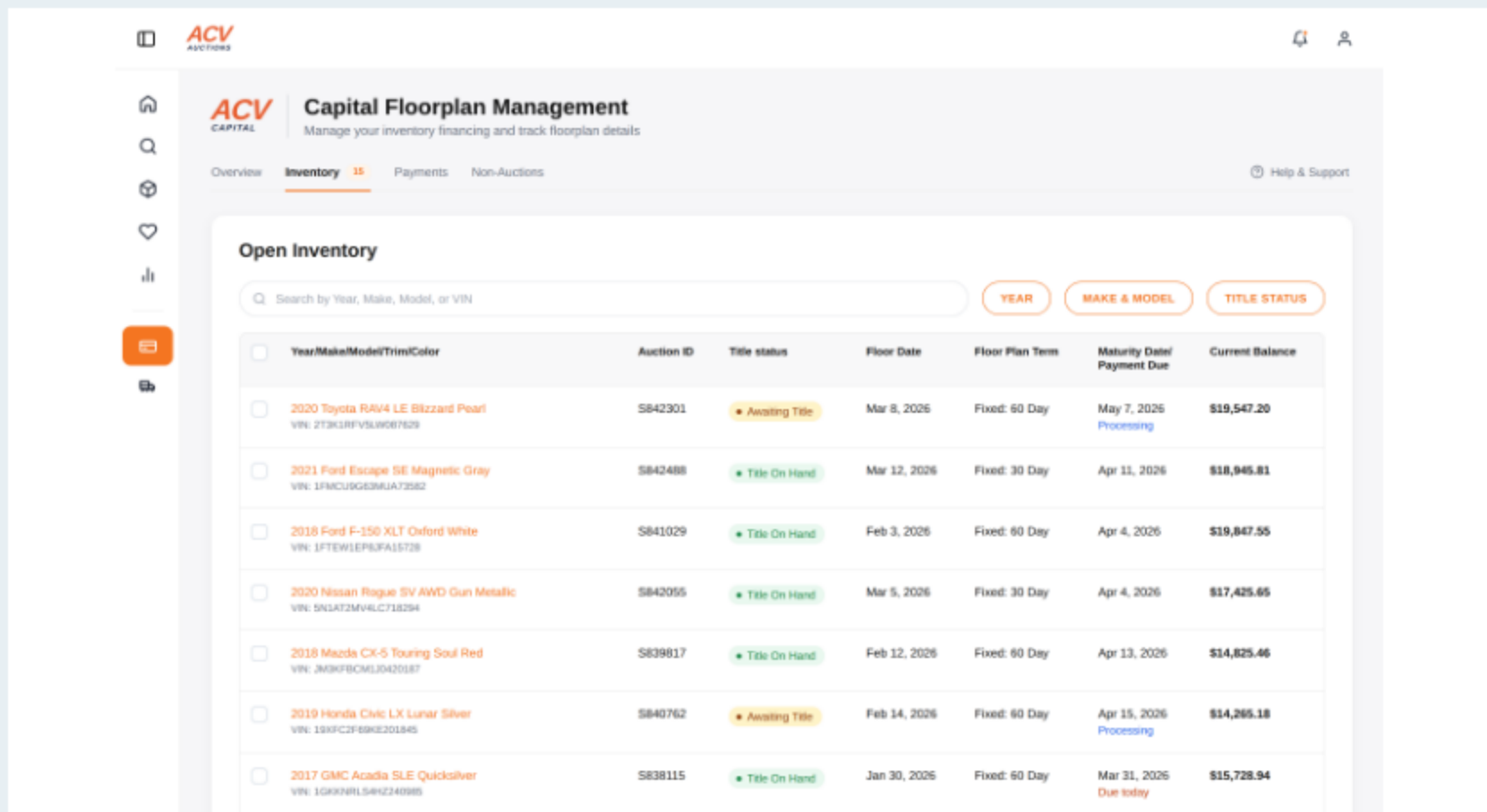


Designing around credit, due dates, and history, not balances, improved clarity and reduced Support calls. We built a decision tool that points dealers to the right action.

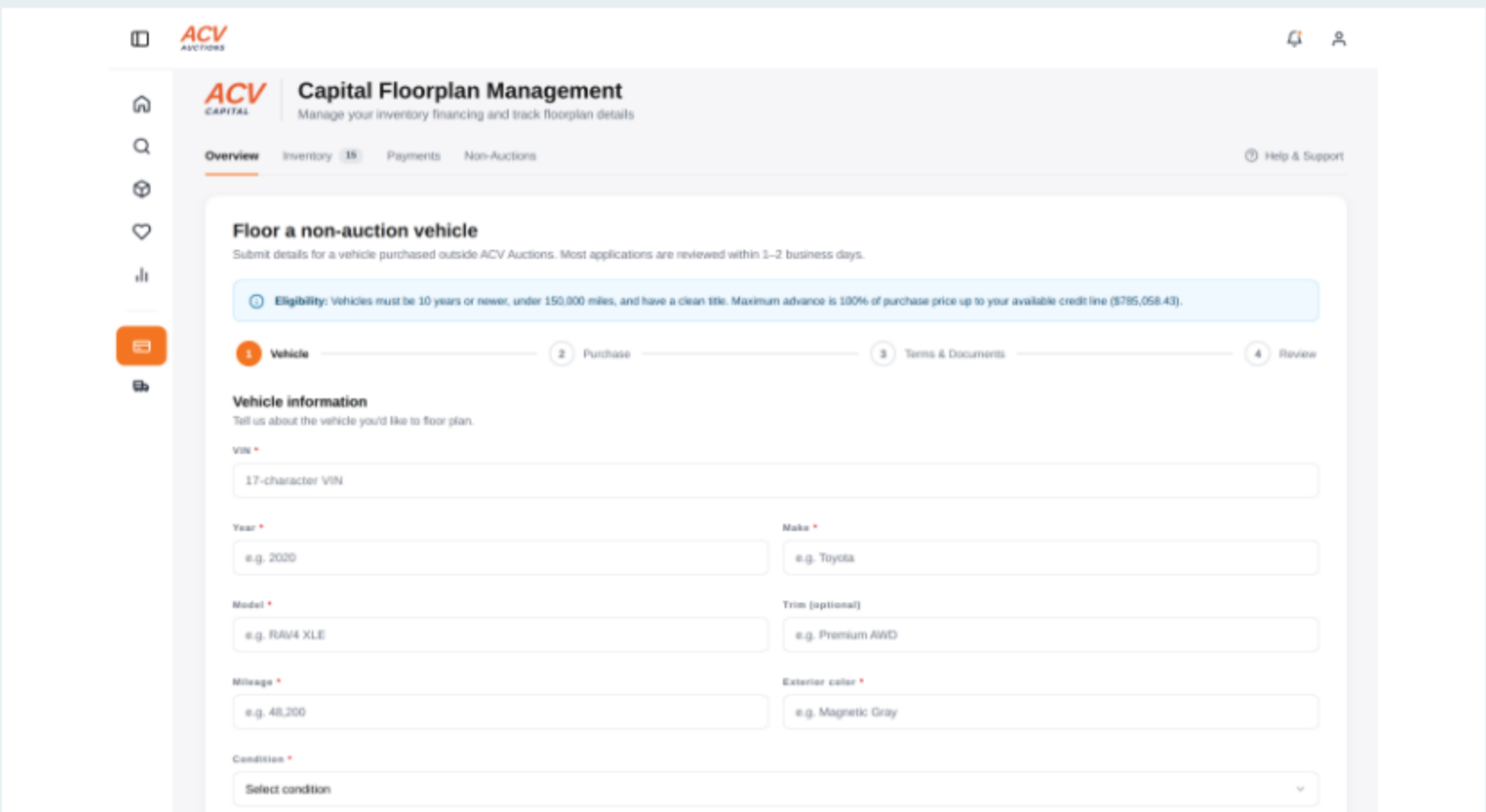


A self-serve floorplan platform with real-time control

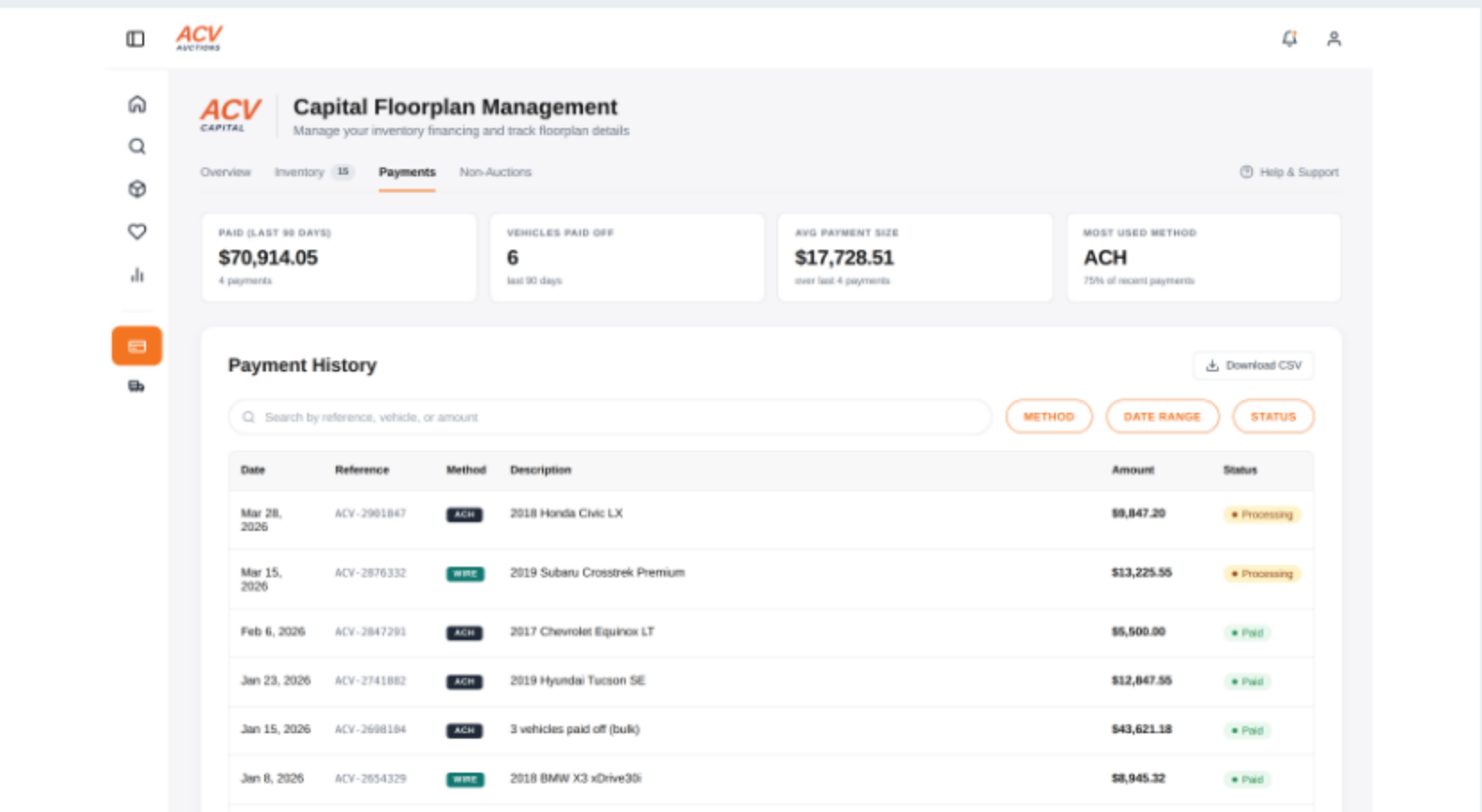
Real-time visibility over inventory, maturities, and payments that replaces the phone calls and the black box.



Inventory: filters, title tracking, bulk pay



Self-serve floor-a-vehicle



Payments: methods, history & status

On-time ↑

Higher on-time payoff rate; fewer late fees

90 days

To active, recurring use

4.6 / 5

Dealer satisfaction, post-launch survey

~2×

Fewer routine inquiries to Ops vs. baseline

"My office managers stopped calling us about balances and titles. They just handle it in the portal now. It changed how we run the floor."

— Shayan K., GM, Capital Operations

*Impact measured against pre-launch baselines from internal reporting. Specific figures redacted for confidentiality.